
Component 2: Externally Set Assignment

Overview

This component is weighted 40% of the total qualification.

This component incorporates **two major elements: preparatory studies and the 15-hour period of sustained focus**. The Externally Set Assignment represents the culmination of the GCE Qualification allowing students to draw together all the knowledge, understanding and skills developed throughout. The Externally Set Assignment consists of one broad-based thematic starting point to which students respond by developing a portfolio of practical work and final outcome(s).

The Externally Set Assignment comprises an externally set theme with suggested starting points. Students will need to develop their own personal work from this theme and related starting points.

It is internally assessed, and externally moderated. The Externally Set Assignment will be available from 1 February of each year. Students can then begin their preparatory studies, culminating in the final 15-hour period of sustained focus under examination conditions. The 15-hour period of sustained focus under examination conditions may take place over multiple sessions (a maximum of five, within three consecutive weeks). All student work must be completed in advance of centres' internal assessment and standardisation.

Preparatory studies

Preparatory studies can help to provide focus for the development of ideas and outcomes. Preparatory studies will be evidenced throughout the creative journey and can take many forms such as recorded research, written annotation and practical exploration and development.

Preparatory studies must be submitted with final outcome(s) produced during the period of 15 hours' sustained focus. The preparatory studies must show the full breadth and depth of students' visual and written critical thinking in the progress of their work.

15-hour period of sustained focus

During the 15-hour period of sustained focus students will produce their final outcome(s) responding to the Externally Set Assignment theme, based on their preparatory studies. This work must be produced unaided under controlled examination conditions. The 15-hour period of sustained focus under examination conditions may take place over multiple sessions (a maximum of five, within three consecutive weeks). Students should plan the best use of the 15 hours to complete all final outcome(s) within this time. Students must not access their work outside of assessment time. Work must not be added to or altered after the 15-hour supervised period has ended.

To summarise:

- preparatory studies will support the work for the period of sustained focus
- knowledge, understanding and skills should primarily be communicated through a portfolio of practical work
- the Externally Set Assignment will be available on 1 February in the year of certification
- the delivery of this component should be planned to include appropriate guidance during the preparatory period (from 1 February until the commencement of the final 15 hours), encouraging students to develop ideas, intentions and response(s) independently
- students must produce work unaided under examination conditions during the 15-hour period of sustained focus
- the 15-hour period of sustained focus under examination conditions may take place over multiple sessions (a maximum of five, within three consecutive weeks)
- work completed as preparatory studies and during the 15-hour period of sustained focus must be presented together for assessment and moderation
- work must not be added to or altered after the 15-hour supervised period has ended
- this component will be assessed using the assessment grid on pages 33–35. Only Assessment Objectives 1 to 4 should be used when assessing students' work.

Assessment grids

Teachers must assess students' work using the criteria in the following assessment grids. The same grids must be used for all titles.

For Component 1 (60% of the qualification):

- Assessment Objectives 1–4 are to be used for practical work and written annotation where present.
- The personal study grid is to be used only for the assessment of the personal study of a minimum 1000 words continuous written prose.

For Component 2 (40% of the qualification):

- Assessment Objectives 1–4 are to be used for the assessment of all practical work and written annotation where present.

Mark bands 1 to 6 each contain three marks. Teachers/assessors must establish whether the work being assessed is in the top, middle or bottom of a given band for each criterion.

Band 0 should be used where work has **not** achieved the required standard for this qualification.

Please use the mark grids in *Appendix 2: Teacher Mark Sheets* when entering marks for assessment of each component by each student.

The following grid relates to all Advanced level student practical work and annotation. The grid assesses all four Assessment Objectives equally.

	0	Level 1 Limited ability			Level 2 Basic ability			Level 3 Emerging competent ability			Level 4 Competent and consistent ability			Level 5 Confident and assured ability			Level 6 Exceptional ability		
Marks	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Objectives	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Assessment Objective 1 Develop ideas through sustained and focused investigations informed by contextual and other sources, demonstrating analytical and critical understanding	No rewardable material	Development of ideas shows limited ability Sustained and focused investigations show limited ability, partially informed by contextual and other sources Limited ability in analytical and critical understanding			Development of ideas shows basic ability Sustained and focused investigations are basic, partially informed by contextual and other sources Basic analytical and critical understanding			Development of ideas shows emerging competence in ability Sustained and focused investigations show emerging competence informed by contextual and other sources Emerging competence in analytical and critical understanding			Development of ideas shows competent and consistent ability Sustained and focused investigations are competent and consistent, informed by contextual and other sources Competent and consistent analytical and critical understanding			Development of ideas shows confident and assured ability Sustained and focused investigations are confident and assured, thoroughly informed by contextual and other sources Confident and assured analytical and critical understanding			Development of ideas shows exceptional ability Sustained and focused investigations are exceptional, thoroughly informed by contextual and other sources Exceptional analytical and critical understanding		
Assessment Objective 2 Explore and select appropriate resources, media, materials, techniques and processes, reviewing and refining ideas as work develops	No rewardable material	Limited ability to explore and select appropriate to intentions Limited ability to review and refine ideas as work develops			Basic ability to explore and select appropriate to intentions Basic ability to review and refine ideas as work develops			Emerging competence in ability to explore and select appropriate to intentions Emerging competence in ability to review and refine ideas as work develops			Competent and consistent ability to explore and select appropriate to intentions Competent and consistent ability to review and refine ideas as work develops			Confident and assured ability to explore and select appropriate to intentions Confident and assured ability to review and refine ideas as work develops			Exceptional ability to explore and select appropriate to intentions Exceptional ability to review and refine ideas as work develops		

	0	Level 1 Limited ability			Level 2 Basic ability			Level 3 Emerging competent ability			Level 4 Competent and consistent ability			Level 5 Confident and assured ability			Level 6 Exceptional ability		
Marks	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Objectives	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Assessment Objective 3 Record ideas, observations and insights relevant to intentions, reflecting critically on work and progress	No rewardable material	Ability to record is limited and partially relevant to intentions Limited ability to reflect critically on work and progress			Ability to record is basic and partially relevant to intentions Basic ability to reflect critically on work and progress			Ability to record shows emerging competence and relevance to intentions Emerging competence in ability to reflect critically on work and progress			Ability to record is competent and consistent, and relevant to intentions Competent and consistent ability to reflect critically on work and progress			Ability to record is confident and assured, and relevant to intentions Confident and assured ability to reflect critically on work and progress			Ability to record is exceptional and relevant to intentions Exceptional ability to reflect critically on work and progress		
Assessment Objective 4 Present a personal and meaningful response that realises intentions and, where appropriate, makes connections between visual and other elements	No rewardable material	Limited ability to present a personal and meaningful response Limited ability to realise intentions and make connections where appropriate			Basic ability to present a personal and meaningful response Basic ability to realise intentions and make connections where appropriate			Emerging competence in ability to present a personal and meaningful response Emerging competence in ability to realise intentions and make connections where appropriate			Competent and consistent ability to present a personal and meaningful response Competent and consistent ability to realise intentions and make connections where appropriate			Confident and assured ability to present a personal and meaningful response Confident and assured ability to realise intentions and make connections where appropriate			Exceptional ability to present a personal and meaningful response Exceptional ability to realise intentions and make connections where appropriate		

The following grid relates only to Advanced level Component 1: Personal Study. The grid relates to all four Assessment Objectives equally.

	0	Level 1 Limited ability			Level 2 Basic ability			Level 3 Emerging competent ability			Level 4 Competent and consistent ability			Level 5 Confident and assured ability			Level 6 Exceptional ability		
Marks	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Objectives																			
Personal Study (AO1/AO2/ AO3/AO4)	No rewardable material	All level descriptions for Level 1 apply in addition to the level description below. Limited ability in use of written communication and specialist terminology			All level descriptions for Level 2 apply in addition to the level description below. Basic use of written communication and specialist terminology			All level descriptions for Level 3 apply in addition to the level description below. Emerging competence in use of written communication and specialist terminology			All level descriptions for Level 4 apply in addition to the level description below. Competent and consistent use of written communication and specialist terminology			All level descriptions for Level 5 apply in addition to the level description below. Use of written communication and specialist terminology is confident and assured, and expresses ideas fluently			All level descriptions for Level 6 apply in addition to the level description below. Use of written communication and specialist terminology is exceptional and expresses complex ideas with authority		

Assignment setting, taking and marking

Assignment setting